

## Installation & Setup For Windows

### For Windows :

#### Step 1: Install VS Code(Code Editor)

- Go to: <https://code.visualstudio.com/>
- While installing: tick these options:
  - "Add to PATH"
  - "Open with Code"

#### Step 2: Install C Extension

- Go to Extensions (left sidebar or Ctrl + Shift + X)
- C/C++ (Microsoft) → install it
- code runner

#### Step 3: Install a C Compiler (MinGW)

- Go here: <https://sourceforge.net/projects/mingw/>
- Click Download.
- Select Packages : In the manager
- Right-click and mark these:
  - mingw32-gcc-g++
  - mingw32-base
- Click Installation → Apply Changes

#### Step 4: Set Environment Variable (VERY IMPORTANT)

If you skip this, your compiler won't work.

- Search "Environment Variables" in Windows
- Click Edit the system environment variables
- Click Environment Variables
- Under System Variables, find Path

- Click Edit → New
- Add this path:
  - C:\MinGW\bin
- Click OK everywhere

## Step 5: Verify Installation

- Open Command Prompt and type:
  - gcc --version
- If you see version info → DONE
- If not → you messed up the PATH. Fix it.

## Step 5: Write and Run a C Program

- Create file - hello.c
- Compile via console :
  - gcc hello.c -o hello.exe
  - hello.exe

## Installation & Setup For Mac

### For Mac :

#### Step 1: Install VS Code(Code Editor)

- Go to: <https://code.visualstudio.com/>
- Download for macOS (Apple Silicon works fine)
- Open .zip
- Drag Visual Studio Code into Applications

#### Step 2: Install Compiler

- Download Xcode from App Store
- Through CMD :
  - Run this command : `xcode-select --install`
  - Verify C is working : `clang --version`

#### Step 3: Install VS Code Extensions

- Open VS Code → Extensions (left sidebar)
- Install :
  - C/C++ (by Microsoft) → REQUIRED
  - Code Runner

#### Step 4: Write and Run a C Program

- Create file - `hello.c`
- Compile via console :
  - `clang hello.c -o hello`
  - `./hello`

## BASICS

- Just like we use Hindi/English to talk to each other...
- We need a language to talk to computers.
- That language is called a **programming language**.
- Examples:
- C, C++, Java, Python, Ruby
- Fun fact: There are **8000+** programming languages in the world!

### What is C?

- C is a programming language used to give instructions to the computer.
- Created by Dennis Ritchie in the 1970s at Bell Labs.
- It's known for being:
  - Fast
  - Efficient
- Used to make operating systems, games, software, and more.

### Can Computers Understand C?

- No! Computers do not understand C or any human language directly.
- Computers only understand Binary Language – 0s and 1s.
  - 1 means current is passing ✓
  - 0 means no current ✗

### Compiler

- A tool that translates your C code into Machine Code (Binary).
- Without a compiler, the computer won't understand your code.





## What is HLL?

- We write programs in HLL(High Level Language) because it is easy for humans to read and write.
- Languages like C, C++, Java, Python are called High-Level Languages.

## What is LLL?

- LLL is close to machine language (like binary 0s and 1s).
- It is difficult for humans but easy for the computer.

## What is Code?

Code is a **set of instructions** written by a person (called a programmer) to tell the computer what to do.

## What is Program?

A program is a **collection of many lines of code** that work together to do a task.

# Memory Types

## Primary Memory

- Directly accessible by the CPU.
- Example: RAM (Random Access Memory) and Cache Memory
- Like a rough notebook – temporary and fast.

## Secondary Memory

- Used for permanent storage.
- Example: Hard Disk, SSD, Pen Drive
- Like your final exam notes – saved permanently.

## RAM, CPU & Cache Memory

### RAM(Temporary Memory)

- Stores active apps/data while system is running.
- Data clears on shutdown.
- Like opening Instagram or YouTube – they load into RAM.

### CPU(Central Processing Unit)

- Brain of the computer – performs all calculations & tasks.
- Works with RAM to process instructions.

### Cache Memory

- Super-fast, very small memory inside/near the CPU.
- Stores frequently used data.
- Like keeping a pen in your hand – for quick access.

## Operating System (OS)

- A system software that manages all hardware and software.
- Examples: Windows, Linux, macOS, Android.
- It acts as a bridge between user and computer hardware.

## Files & Folders

- File = A single document (text, image, video, etc.)
- Folder = A container to organize multiple files.
- Like a library: Folders = shelves, Files = books.

## Terminal / CMD

- A text-based interface to interact with the computer.
- Used to run commands directly.
- OS examples:
  - Windows: CMD (Command Prompt)
  - macOS/Linux: Terminal

## Common Terminal Commands

### Command

### Description

|                  |                                          |
|------------------|------------------------------------------|
| cd foldername    | Change directory (move into a folder)    |
| mkdir foldername | Make/create a new folder                 |
| ls / dir         | List files/folders in the current folder |
| del file.txt     | Delete a file                            |
| cls/clear        | Clear the screen                         |

## Environmental Variables

- Store system-level settings like:
  - Where programs are installed
  - Default paths, user info, etc.
- Example: After installing a C compiler, we add its path to environment variables so the system can find and run it from anywhere.



# Comments & Variables

## Comments

- Comments are notes or explanations you write in your code.
- The computer ignores them. They're only for humans to understand the code better.

## Types of C

- Single Line Comment - `// This is a comment`
- Multi-line comment -

## Syntax

- Just like English has grammar rules, C has coding rules.
- Syntax means the rules of the language.
- If you break the syntax, you get an error.

## Keywords vs Words

- Special **reserved words** in C, that have special meaning and cannot be used as variable names are called Keywords.
- auto, break, case, char, const, continue, default, do, double, else, enum, extern, float, for, goto, if, int, long, register, return, short, signed, sizeof, static, struct, switch, typedef, union, unsigned, void, volatile, while

## Variables

- A variable is a container that stores data like numbers, characters, etc.
- This value can be changed during the execution of the program.
- Before use, you need to declare and define it.

## Variable Declaration

- `int age;`

## Variable Initialisation

- `age = 18;`

## Variable Declaration & Initialisation

- `int age = 18;`

## Rules for Naming Variables

- Must start with an alphabet or underscore \_
- Can end with digit.
- Special characters allowed: \_ and \$ only.
- Cannot use keywords.
- C is case-sensitive.

## Code Readability

When you name your variables or functions, follow a good style.

Use either of these two:

- camelCase – First word small, then every next word starts with Capital letter.  
e.g : `studentName`
- snake\_case – All words are in small letters, and you use \_ (underscore) to separate them.  
e.g : `student_name;`

## Data Types

C is a statically typed language

- You must declare the type of every variable.
- Once declared, the type cannot be changed.
- This is because each type uses different memory and supports specific operations.

### Types of Data

#### 1. Primitive Data Types

- The most basic data types that are used for representing simple values.
- int, char, float, double, void

#### 2. Derived Data Types

- Derived from the primitive or built-in datatypes.
- array, pointers, function

#### 3. User Defined Data Types

- Defined by the user himself.
- structure, union, enum

### Format Specifier

Special token that begin with % symbol, followed by a character that specifies the data type.

#### Format Specifier

%c

%d, %i

%f

%ld or %li

#### Description

For character type.

For signed integer type.

For float type.

Long

## Format Specifier

|              |                               |
|--------------|-------------------------------|
| %lf          | Double                        |
| %lu          | Unsigned int or unsigned long |
| %lli or %lld | Long long                     |
| %llu         | Unsigned long long            |
| %u           | Unsigned int                  |
| %p           | Pointer                       |
| %s           | String                        |

## Escape Sequence

|    |   |               |
|----|---|---------------|
| \t | - | Tab           |
| \n | - | NewLine       |
| \b | - | Backspace     |
| \" | - | Double quotes |
| \' | - | Single quotes |
| \\ | - | Backslash     |
| \? | - | Question mark |
| %% | - | Percentage    |



## Input and Output

Reading data from user or external sources

- C provides a standard set of functions.
- These functions are part of the standard input/output library `<stdio.h>`.
- Most commonly used functions for Input is `scanf()`.

### `scanf()`

- used to read user input from the console
- Syntax : `scanf("formatted_string", address_of_variables/values);`

Example :

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main() {
    int age;
    printf("Enter your age: ");
    // Reads an integer
    scanf("%d", &age);
    // Prints the age
    printf("Age is: %d\n", age);
    return 0;
}
```

### Problem: Reading char after int

- When taking a char after reading an int, it may not work as expected.
- Reason: `scanf()` leaves a newline (`\n`) in the buffer.

## What is a Buffer?

- When we give input in C (like typing into the console), it goes through a buffer – a temporary memory area that stores what we type before it gets processed.
- If you type: 5↵, you're actually typing two characters:  
5 → the digit  
'\n' → the newline character when you press Enter (↵)

## How scanf() works

- scanf() reads the 5 from the buffer and stores it in x. But the newline character \n (from pressing Enter) is left behind in the buffer.
- So the buffer now still contains: \n
- Now, if you write:  
char ch;  
scanf("%c", &ch);
- It immediately reads the \n left in the buffer and stores it in ch. You think you're reading a character (like y), but it reads newline instead!

## Solution

1. Use a space before %c to tell scanf() to skip any whitespace, including: Spaces, Tabs, Newlines (\n).

```
scanf(" %c", &ch);
```

2. Use fflush(stdin): Clears the input buffer to remove any leftover characters (such as spaces, tabs, or newlines) before reading input.

```
fflush(stdin); // Clears the input buffer  
scanf("%c", &ch); // Reads the next character
```

# Operators

Operators are symbols used to perform operations on variables and values. The values and variables used with operators are called **operands**.

## Types of Operator

### 1. Arithmetic Operators :

It divided into two categories -

- a. **+, -, \*, /** (int/int will always yield int) , **%** (Return remainder after dividing two numbers).

Special powers of / & % by powers of 10

/ : to reduce the number by 1 digit

% : to get last digit(s) of number.

- b. **Increment (++) and Decrement (--) Operators**

1. Pre-Increment/Decrement(++a/ --a) : The value is increased/decreased first, then used in the expression.



```
int a = 5;  
int b = ++a; // a becomes 6, then b =  
6
```

2. Post-Increment/Decrement(a++/ a--) : The value is used first, then increased/decreased.

### Rules:

1. Can only be used with variables, not constants.
  -  a++;
  -  5++; → Not allowed
2. Works only with numeric data types (int, float, etc.), not with strings or arrays.

## 2. Relational Operators

- Used to compare two values. Returns 1 for true, 0 for false.
- <, >, <=, >=, ==, !=
- Equal To (==)  
Checks if two operands are equal.
- Not Equal To (!=)  
Checks if two operands are not equal.
- Greater Than or Equal To (>=)  
Checks if one operand is either greater than or equal to the other.
- Less Than or Equal To (<=)  
Checks if one operand is either less than or equal to the other.

## 3. Logical Operators

- Used for combining multiple conditions.
- &&, ||, !

### Logical AND Operator(&&)

Returns true when both conditions under evaluation are true, otherwise it returns false.

e.g : if(a>b && a);

### Logical OR Operator(||)

Returns true if any one of the given conditions is true, otherwise it returns false. It returns false if and only if both conditions under evaluation are false.

e.g : if(a>b || a<c) System.out.println("Max : " + a);

## Logical Not Operator(!)

It accepts a single value as an input and returns the inverse of the same. This is a unary operator unlike the AND and OR operators.

e.g : `if(!(a<c)) System.out.println("Max : " + a);`

## 4. Assignment Operators

- Used to assign and update values.
- `+=`, `-=`, `*=`, `/=`, `%=`
- Example : `a = a+5`, we can write `a += 5`.

## 5. sizeof Operators

- Used to get the size in bytes of a data type or variable.
- `sizeof(int)` // Output: 4 (usually)

## Header Files

A header file contains pre-written code (like functions, constants, macros) that we can use in our programs to save time and effort.

We use `#include` to include a header file at the top of our code.

`#include <header_file_name.h>`

### Common Header Files

- `stdio.h`      -      For input/output functions like `printf()` and `scanf()`
- `stdlib.h`    -      For general functions like memory allocation, etc.
- `string.h`    -      For string functions like `strlen()`, `strcpy()`, `strcmp()`
- `math.h`      -      For math functions like `sqrt()`, `pow()`, `ceil()`, `floor()`

Functions from `math.h`

- `sqrt(x)`      -      Square root of  $x$
- `pow(x, y)`    -       $x$  raised to the power  $y$
- `ceil(x)`      -      Smallest integer  $\geq x$  (round up)
- `floor(x)`     -      Largest integer  $\leq x$  (round down)

# Control Flow Statements

Programs can make decisions based on conditions. This is called decision making, and the statements used for it are called conditional statements.

## Types of Conditional Statements

### 1. if Statement

- Used to check one condition.
- If the condition is true, the block runs.

Syntax :

```
if (condition) {  
    // code runs if condition is true  
}
```

Example :

```
if (age > 18) {  
    printf("You can vote");  
}
```

### 2. if-else Statement

- Adds an alternative if the condition is false.

Syntax :

```
if (condition) {  
    // code if true  
} else {  
    // code if false  
}
```

Example :

```
if (marks >= 40) {  
    printf("Pass");  
} else {  
    printf("Fail");  
}
```

### 3. if-else if-else Ladder

- Used to check multiple conditions one by one.
- As soon as one condition is true, its block runs and the rest are skipped.  
If none are true, the final else runs.

Syntax :

```
if (condition1) {  
    // if condition1 true  
} else if (condition2) {  
    // if condition2 true  
} else {  
    // if none true  
}
```



Example :

```
if (marks >= 90) {  
    printf("Grade A");  
} else if (marks >= 75) {  
    printf("Grade B");  
} else {  
    printf("Grade C");  
}
```

#### 4. if Ladder (Multiple Independent ifs)

- All conditions are checked separately, even if one is already true.

Syntax :

```
if (condition1) {  
    // code  
}  
if (condition2) {  
    // code  
}  
.
```

Example :

```
if (num % 2 == 0) {  
    printf("Even");  
}  
if (num % 3 == 0) {  
    printf("Divisible by 3");  
}
```

## Advance Control Flow

### Ternary Operator

- Shorthand for if-else
- Syntax : condition ? value\_if\_true : value\_if\_false;
  - If the condition is true, the expression after the ? gets executed.
  - If the condition is false, the expression after the : gets executed.

Example :

```
int age = 20;

// Using ternary operator to decide eligibility
(age >= 18) ? printf("You are eligible to vote.\n") :
printf("You are not eligible to vote.\n");
```

### Type Conversion

- Implicit Casting: Done automatically by the compiler.  
(e.g., int to float)
- Explicit Casting: Explicit type conversion (also called type casting) is used when you want to manually convert one data type into another.

Syntax : (data\_type) value;

```
int a = 5, b = 2;
float result;

result = (float)a / b; // cast a to float

printf("Result = %.2f", result);
```

## Switch Statement

- Switch statement allows executing one block of code from many based on the value of an expression.
- It's a cleaner alternative to multiple if-else conditions.

Syntax :

```
switch (expression) {  
    case value1:  
        // code  
        break;  
    case value2:  
        // code  
        break;  
    default:  
        // default code  
}
```

Example :

```
#include <stdio.h>  
int main() {  
    int day = 3;  
    switch (day) {  
        case 1:  
            printf("Monday\n");  
            break;  
        case 2:  
            printf("Tuesday\n");  
            break;  
        case 3:  
            printf("Wednesday\n");  
            break;  
        case 4:  
            printf("Thursday\n");  
            break;  
        case 5:  
            printf("Friday\n");  
            break;  
        default:  
            printf("Weekend\n");  
    }  
    return 0;  
}
```

### Key Points:

- Works with `int` and `char` types only.
- Each case must have a `unique` value.
- `break` is `optional` but prevents `fall-through`.
- `default` is optional; runs if no match.
- Nesting of `switch` is allowed.
- `default` can be placed anywhere.

### Fall-through in switch Statement

- Fall-through occurs in a switch statement when `break` is not used after a case.
- This causes the control to continue executing the next case(s) even if they don't match the expression until `break` found.

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main() {
    int num = 2;

    switch (num) {
        case 1:
            printf("One\n");
        case 2:
            printf("Two\n");
        case 3:
            printf("Three\n");
        default:
            printf("Default\n");
    }

    return 0;
}
```

Output :

Two

Three

Default

## Using Range in switch Case

You can use a range of numbers instead of a single number or character in the case statement.

That is the case range extension of the GNU C compiler and not standard C.

Syntax

case low ... high:

- Matches any value between low and high (inclusive).
- Only works in GCC.

Example:

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main() {
    int arr[] = { 1, 5, 15, 20 };

    for (int i = 0; i < 4; i++) {
        switch (arr[i]) {
            case 1 ... 6:
                printf("%d in range 1 to 6\n", arr[i]);
                break;
            case 19 ... 20:
                printf("%d in range 19 to 20\n", arr[i]);
                break;
            default:
                printf("%d not in range\n", arr[i]);
                break;
        }
    }
    return 0;
}
```

Output:

1 in range 1 to 6

5 in range 1 to 6

15 not in range

20 in range 19 to 20

# Loops

## Why Loops are Necessary

- Sometimes we need to repeat the same code multiple times.
- Using printf() repeatedly (e.g., 100 or 1000 times) is inefficient.
- Loops help reduce redundancy and improve code readability.

## What are Loops?

- Loops allow repeating a block of code until a condition is met.
- Saves time and avoids rewriting code.
- Used for automation and iteration in programs.

## Types of Loops

### 1. Entry-Controlled Loops:

Condition is checked before executing the loop body.

- for loop
- while loop

### 2. Exit-Controlled Loop:

Condition is checked after executing the loop body.

- do-while loop

## for Loop

- Repeats a block of code a known number of times.

Syntax :

```
for (initialization; condition; updation) {  
    // loop body  
}
```

Example :



```
for (int i = 0; i < 5; i++) {  
    printf("%d ", i);  
}
```

## Infinite Loops

- An infinite loop is a loop that never terminates on its own.
- The condition is always true or there is no condition at all.

Example :



```
for(;;) {  
    // runs forever  
}
```



```
for(;;);
```

Since no condition is specified, it never becomes false.

## Break Statement

- Exits from the loop immediately.

Example :



```
for (int i = 0; i < 10; i++) {  
    if (i == 5)  
        break;  
}
```

Output :

The loop runs 5 times but shows no output as there's no print statement. It exits on the 6th iteration due to break.

## Continue

- Skips current iteration and moves to the next.

Example :



```
for (int i = 0; i < 5; i++) {  
    if (i == 2)  
        continue;  
    printf("%d ", i);  
}
```

Output :

0 1 3 4

The loop prints all values except 2 because continue skips the iteration when i == 2.



# Flowcharts

## Flowchart

- A flowchart is a diagrammatic representation of an algorithm or logic.
- It shows the step-by-step flow of solving a problem.
- Used before coding to plan and visualize the logic clearly.

## Why Use Flowcharts

- Helps in understanding and organizing logic before coding.
- Useful for debugging and finding logical errors early.
- Makes it easier to explain your approach to others, especially in group projects.
- Acts as a visual documentation of your program.
- Gives a clear idea of the execution path.

## Flowchart Symbols

- **Terminators**

**Start**

Used to denote the start point of the program.

**End**

Used to denote the end point of the program.

- **Input/Output**



Read n

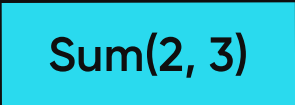
Used for taking input from the user and store it in variable 'n'.



Print n

Used to output value stored in variable 'n'.

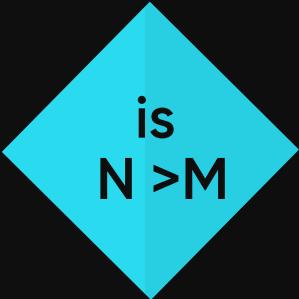
- **Processing**



Sum(2, 3)

Used to perform the operation(s) in the program. For example: Sum(2, 3) just performs arithmetic summation of the numbers 2 and 3.

- **Condition**



is  
N > M

Used to make decision(s) in the program means it depends on some condition & answers in the form of TRUE(for yes) and FALSE(for no).

- **Arrows**



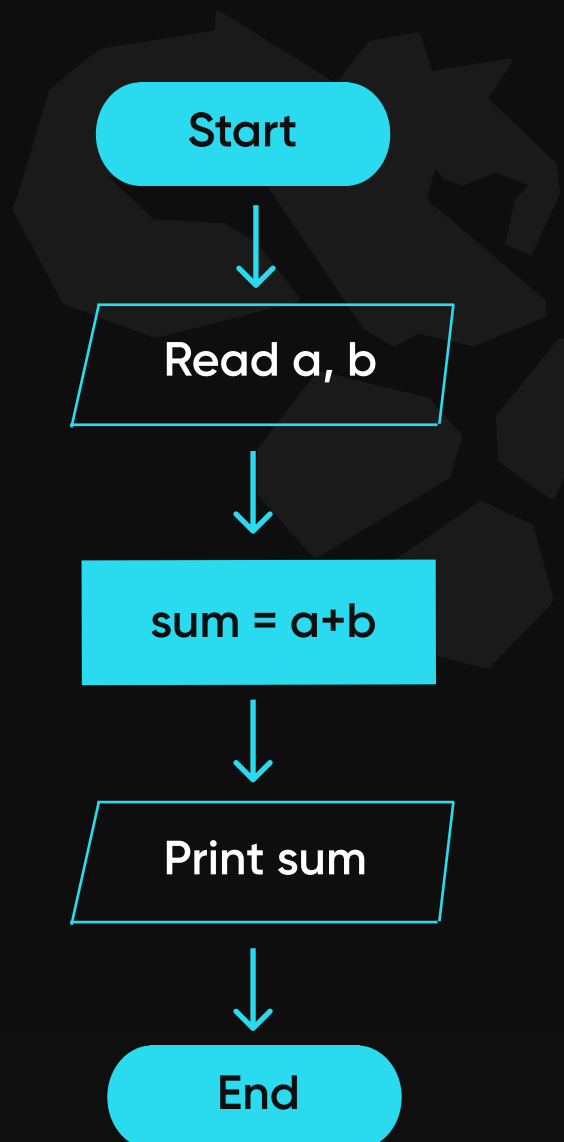
Generally, used to show the flow of the program from one step to another. The head of the arrow shows the next step and the tail shows the previous one.

- **Connector**



Used to connect different parts of the program and are used in case of break-through. Generally, used for functions(which we will study in our further sections).

- **Example : Flowchart of Adding Two Numbers a & b**



## while Loop

### while Loop

- The while loop executes repeatedly as long as the condition is true.
- It is suitable when the number of iterations is not known in advance.

Syntax :

```
while (condition) {  
    // code block to be executed  
}
```

Example :

```
int i = 1;  
while (i <= 5) {  
    printf("Count: %d ", i);  
    i++;  
}
```

Output :

Count: 1 Count: 2 Count: 3 Count: 4 Count: 5

### Infinite while Loop

- loop runs forever unless you use break, an external condition, or terminate the program manually.

Example :



```
while(1) {  
    // runs infinitely  
}
```



## do-while Loop

### do-while Loop

- Executes the loop at least once, regardless of whether the condition is true or false
- Useful when you want the loop body to run at least one time, such as showing a menu before checking input

Syntax :

```
do {  
    // body of loop  
} while(condition);
```

Example :

```
int i = 1;  
do {  
    printf("%d ", i);  
    i++;  
} while(i <= 5);
```

Output :

1 2 3 4 5

# Nested Loops

## Nested Loop

- A nested loop means having one loop inside another loop.
- We can define any number of loops inside another loop.

Syntax :

```
for ( initialization; condition; increment ) {  
    for ( initialization; condition; increment ) {  
        // statement of inside loop  
    }  
    // statement of outer loop  
}
```

Example :

```
// Outer loop for rows  
for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {  
    // Inner loop for columns  
    for (int j = 0; j < n; j++) {  
        printf("* ");  
    }  
    printf("\n"); // Move to next row  
}
```

Output :

```
* * * *  
* * * *  
* * * *  
* * * *
```

# Functions

## Functions

- A function is a set of statements that perform a specific task when called.
- It promotes modularity and code reusability.

## Syntax of Functions

The syntax of functions can be divided into three main parts:

1. Function Declaration (Prototype)
2. Function Definition
3. Function Call

### 1. Function Declaration (Prototype)

The syntax of functions can be divided into three main parts:

- Declares the function before its use.
- Tells the compiler about the function name, return type, and parameters.
- Syntax: `return_type function_name(parameter_list);`

### 2. Function Definition

- Contains the actual body (code) of the function.
- Syntax :  

```
return_type function_name(parameter_list) {  
    // statements  
}
```

### 3. Function Call

- Executes the function using its name and arguments.
- Syntax:  
`function_name(arguments);`



## Return Types

- Specifies what type of value the function will return.
- If a function doesn't return anything, we use `void` as return type.

Example :

```
void greet(); // returns nothing
int add();    // returns an int
```

## Parameters (Arguments)

- Inputs passed to a function for processing.
- Declared in the function definition and prototype.
- Can have zero or more parameters.

Example :

```
void printName(char name[]); // takes one parameter
int sum(int a, int b);       // takes two parameters
```

## Passing Parameters to Functions

- The values/variables passed to a function during the function call are `actual parameters`.
- The variables used in the function definition to receive the values are `formal parameters`.

Example :

```
#include <stdio.h>

void addTen(int x) { //Formal Parameters
    x = x + 10;
    printf(" x = %d\n", x);
}

int main() {
    int num = 5;
    addTen(num); //Actual Parameters
    printf("Outside function: num = %d\n", num);
    return 0;
}
```

## Ways to pass parameters

We can pass arguments to the function in two ways:

1. Pass by Value
2. Pass by Reference

### 1. Pass by Value

- A copy of the actual parameter is passed to the function.
- Changes made inside the function do not affect the original variable.
- Value inside main function remains same.

Example :

```
#include <stdio.h>

void swap(int var1, int var2){
    int temp = var1;
    var1 = var2;
    var2 = temp;
}

int main(){
    int var1 = 3, var2 = 2;
    printf("Before swap var1 and var2 : %d, %d\n",
        var1, var2);
    swap(var1, var2);
    printf("After swap var1 and var2 : %d, %d",
        var1, var2);
    return 0;
}
```

**Output :**

Before swap var1 and var2 : 3, 2

After swap var1 and var2 : 3, 2

## 2. Pass by Reference (DTL)

- In Pass by Reference, the memory address of the variable is passed to the function.
- Changes made to the parameter inside the function directly affect the original variable.

# Recursion

## What is Recursion?

- Recursion = a function calling itself.
- Used when a problem can be broken into smaller identical subproblems.
- Continues until a base case stops it.

## Core Components of Recursion

### 1. Base Case

- Condition where recursion stops
- Prevents infinite calls
- Smallest possible input

```
if(n == 0) return 1;
```

### 2. Recursive Case

- Function calls itself with smaller input.

```
return n * factorial(n-1);
```

### 3. How Recursion Works (Call Stack)

- Each function call goes into stack memory
- Execution pauses until inner calls return

```
main() → f(3)  
      → f(2)  
      → f(1)  
      → f(0) ← base case
```

- Then returns back:

$f(0) \rightarrow f(1) \rightarrow f(2) \rightarrow f(3)$

#### 4. Example: Factorial Program

```
#include <stdio.h>

int factorial(int n) {
    if(n == 0) // base case
        return 1;
    return n * factorial(n - 1); // recursive case
}

int main() {
    printf("%d", factorial(5));
    return 0;
}
```

#### 5. Step-by-Step Execution (factorial(3))

```
factorial(3)
= 3 * factorial(2)
= 3 * 2 * factorial(1)
= 3 * 2 * 1 * factorial(0)
= 3 * 2 * 1 * 1
= 6
```

# Arrays

## Why?

- Suppose you want to store the names of 1000 people.
- One way is to create 1000 different variables but this is not only time-consuming and inefficient, but also difficult to manage.
- At that time we use an array that can store multiple values under a single variable name.

## What is Array?

- An array is a fixed-size collection of similar data items.
- All elements in an array are stored in contiguous memory locations.
- It used to store a group of values under a single variable name.

## Declaration of Array

Syntax :

```
data_type array_name [size];
```

Example :

```
int arr[5];
```

## Initialization

- Array Initialization with Declaration

```
data_type array_name[] = {1,2,3,4,5};
```

- Array Initialization with Declaration without Size

```
data_type array_name [size] = {value1, value2, ... valueN};
```

## Array Addressing(Contiguous Memory Allocation)

- Contiguous Memory: Array elements are stored in sequential (contiguous) memory locations.
- Hexadecimal Addressing: Internally, memory addresses are in hexadecimal format (e.g., 0x100, 0x104, 0x108, etc.).
- Base Address: The memory address of the first element in the array is called the base address.
- Access by Index: Array elements are accessed using index numbers, starting from 0.
- Address Calculation Formula:

**Address of arr[i] = Base address + (i \* size of data type)**

- Example: If Base Address = 100 and size of int = 4 bytes, then
  - arr[0] → 100
  - arr[1] → 104
  - arr[2] → 108
  - And so on...

## 2D Array

Arrays are used to store multiple values of the same data type in a single variable.

Based on the number of dimensions, arrays can be classified into two types:

### 1. One Dimensional Array (1D Array)

- These arrays have only one row of elements, like a simple list.
- Used when you want to store a sequence of items, like marks of students, prices, etc.

### 2. Multidimensional Array

- Multidimensional arrays are arrays with more than one dimension.
- Used when data needs to be stored in tabular or grid-like format. Common types:
  - 2D Arrays – Tables, matrices.
  - 3D Arrays – Cubes or multi-layered data.
- Arrays beyond 3D are possible but rarely used due to complexity and memory usage.

### 2D Array

- A 2D array is essentially an array of arrays.
- It can be visualized like a table with rows and columns.

### Declaration

```
data_type array_name[size1][size2];
```



## Initialization

- `int matrix[2][3] = {  
    {1, 2, 3},  
    {4, 5, 6}  
};`
- `int matrix[2][3] = {1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6}; // Same result`

## Accessing Elements

- You can access elements using two indices:
- `printf("%d", matrix[1][2]); // Output: 6 (2nd row, 3rd column)`

## Traversing a 2D Array

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main(){
    // declaring and initializing 2d array
    int arr[2][3] = { 10, 20, 30, 40, 50, 60 };

    printf("2D Array:\n");
    // printing 2d array
    for (int i = 0; i < 2; i++) {
        for (int j = 0; j < 3; j++) {
            printf("%d ", arr[i][j]);
        }
        printf("\n");
    }
    return 0;
}
```

Output :

1 2 3

4 5 6

# Strings

A String is a **sequence of characters** terminated with a null character `'\0'`.

```
char str[] = {'s', 'h', 'e', 'r', 'y', '\0'};
```

## Declaration

- Declare as a one-dimensional array.

```
char string_name[size];
```

## String Initialization

1. Assigning a String Literal without Size

```
char str[] = "GeeksforGeeks";
```

2. Assigning a String Literal with a Predefined Size

```
char str[50] = "GeeksforGeeks";
```

### 3. Assigning Character by Character with Size

```
char str[14] = {  
'G','e','e','k','s','f','o','r','G','e','e',  
'k','s','\0'};
```

### 4. Assigning Character by Character without Size

```
char str[] = {  
'G','e','e','k','s','f','o','r','G','e','e',  
'k','s','\0'};
```

#### NOTE :

- In C, when a string is enclosed in double quotes (" "), the compiler **automatically** adds a null character '\0' at the end.
- This '\0' marks the end of the string and is essential for string operations.

## Read String Input

### 1. Using `scanf()`

- Used to read single-word strings (stops at whitespace).
- Example:

```
char name[50];  
scanf("%s", name);
```

### 2. Using `gets()` (Deprecated)

- Reads a full line including spaces until newline (\n) is encountered.
- Deprecated due to buffer overflow issues (unsafe).

- Example

```
char name[50];  
gets(name); // Not recommended
```

### 3. Using `fgets()` (Recommended)

- Safely reads a string including spaces.
- Reads until newline or given size - 1.
- Automatically appends null character (`\0`).
- Syntax : `fgets(name, size, stdin);`
- Example

```
char name[50];  
fgets(name, 50, stdin);
```

### 4. Using `scanf()` with Scanset

- Reads a full line with spaces until a newline is encountered.
- `%[^\n]s`: Tells `scanf` to read everything until a newline (`\n`).
- Example

```
char str[100];  
scanf("%[^\n]s", str);
```

## Common String Functions

- You need to include the header: `#include <string.h>`
- Some functions are :

- `strlen(str)` : Returns the length of the string string(excluding the null character `\0`).
- `strcpy(dest, src)` : Copies the content of one string into another.
- `strcmp(str1, str2)` : Compares two strings. Return 0 if both strings are equal, +ve if `str1 < str2`, -ve if `str1 > str2` (based on ASCII).
- `strcat(dest, src)` : Concatenates (joins) two strings.

## Example

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <string.h>

int main() {
    char src[] = "Hello";
    char dest[20];
    strcpy(dest, src); // dest becomes "Hello"
    int len = strlen(src); //5
    strcmp("apple", "apple"); // Returns 0
    strcmp("apple", "ball"); // Returns -ve < 0

    char a[20] = "Hello ";
    char b[] = "World";
    strcat(a, b); // a becomes "Hello World"
    return 0;
}
```

# Pointers

- A pointer is a variable that stores the **memory address** of another variable.
- It doesn't hold the actual value, but the address of where that value is stored.
- This allows us to **manipulate** the data stored at a specific memory location without actually using its variable.

## Declaration

```
data_type* pointer_name;
```

- data\_type specifies the type of variable the pointer will point to.
- The \* symbol indicates that the variable is a pointer.

Example :

```
int *ptr;      // pointer to an integer
float *fptr;   // pointer to a float
char *cptr;    // pointer to a character
```

## Initializing a Pointer

A pointer is initialized by assigning it the address of a variable using the & (address-of) operator.

```
int a = 10;
int *ptr = &a; // ptr stores the address of variable a
```

- Now, ptr points to a and can be used to access or modify the value of a indirectly.

## Dereference a Pointer

- Accessing the value stored at the memory address(pointer points to).

Example

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main() {
    int var = 10;

    // Pointer storing the address of var
    int* ptr = &var;

    // Direct access (prints address)
    printf("%p\n", ptr);

    // Dereferencing to get value (prints 10)
    printf("%d\n", *ptr);

    return 0;
}
```

**var**

10

X102

**ptr**

X102

X110

- If you print \*ptr(value it ptr) it will print 10.

## Passing Pointer to Function

- In this method, we pass the address (memory location) of variables to the function.
- This is also called Pass by Reference.
- Changes made inside the function are reflected in the original variables, since both point to the same memory location.

### Why use this?

- Allows functions to modify actual variables.
- Useful for swapping, modifying arrays, and for performance in large data structures.
- Also saves memory and time by avoiding data copying.

### Example: Swapping Two Values Using Pointers

```
#include <stdio.h>
// Function to swap two values using pointers
void swap(int* a, int* b){
    int temp = *a;
    *a = *b;
    *b = temp;
}
int main(){
    int x = 10, y = 20;

    // Passing addresses of x and y
    swap(&x, &y);
    printf("Values after swap a:%d, b:%d", x, y);
    return 0;
}
```



## Pointer to Pointer(Double Pointer)

- A pointer to pointer (or double pointer) is a variable that stores the address of another pointer variable.

**var**

10

X102

**ptr**

X102

X110

**dptr**

X110

X120

## Declaration

- `int **ptr;` means ptr is a pointer to a pointer to an integer.

```
data_type **pointer_name;
```

## Example

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main() {
    int num = 100;

    // Single pointer
    int *ptr = &num;

    // Double pointer
    int **dptr = &ptr;

    // Printing values
    printf("Value of num: %d\n", num);
    printf("Value using *ptr: %d\n", *ptr);
    printf("Value using **dptr: %d\n", **dptr);

    return 0;
}
```

## Dynamic Memory Allocation

- Arrays have fixed sizes defined at compile time.
- Problems with static allocation:
  - a. May not fit all required data.
  - b. May waste memory if oversized.
- Dynamic Memory Allocation (DMA) lets you:
  - Allocate memory at runtime.
  - **Resize** memory as needed.
  - Optimize memory usage.

### Functions for Dynamic Memory Allocation

These are provided by the `<stdlib.h>` header:

- **malloc()**      Allocates memory block (uninitialized)
- **calloc()**      Allocates memory block (initialized to 0)
- **free()**        Frees allocated memory
- **realloc()**     Resizes the previously allocated memory

### malloc() – Memory Allocation

- Allocates a single block of memory of given size (in bytes).
- Returns a void pointer to the first byte of the block.
- Memory is uninitialized (contains garbage values).
- Returns NULL if memory allocation fails.

Syntax



```
ptr = (type *) malloc(size_in_bytes);
```

## Example

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>

int main() {
    // Allocating memory for 5 integers (5 * 4 bytes = 20 bytes)
    int *ptr = (int *)malloc(5 * sizeof(int));

    // Check if memory allocation is successful
    if (ptr == NULL) {
        printf("Memory allocation failed!");
        return 1;
    }

    // Assign and print values
    for (int i = 0; i < 5; i++) {
        ptr[i] = i + 1;
        printf("%d ", ptr[i]);
    }
    return 0;
}
```

Output :

1 2 3 4 5

## calloc() – Contiguous Allocation

- calloc() stands for contiguous allocation.
- Similar to malloc(), but with one key difference:
  - Initializes all allocated memory to zero.

## Syntax

```
ptr = (type *) calloc(number_of_elements, size_of_each_element);
```

## Example

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>

int main() {
    // Allocating memory for 5 integers and initializing them to 0
    int *ptr = (int *)calloc(5, sizeof(int));

    // Check if memory allocation is successful
    if (ptr == NULL) {
        printf("Allocation Failed");
        exit(0);
    }

    // Print values (all will be 0)
    for (int i = 0; i < 5; i++) {
        printf("%d ", ptr[i]);
    }
    return 0;
}
```

Output :

0 0 0 0 0

## free()

- Memory allocated using malloc() or calloc() is not freed automatically.
- free() is used to release dynamically allocated memory back to the OS.
- Helps to prevent memory leaks.

## Syntax

```
free(ptr);
```

## Example



```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>

int main() {
    int *ptr = (int *)calloc(5, sizeof(int));
    // Print values
    for (int i = 0; i < 5; i++)
        printf("%d ", ptr[i]);
    // Free the memory
    free(ptr);
    ptr = NULL;

    return 0;
}
```

- After `free()`, the pointer becomes invalid.
- Always set the pointer to `NULL` after freeing:

## **realloc() – Resize Allocated Memory**

- `realloc()` is used to resize a previously allocated memory block.
- Can expand or shrink the size of the memory.
- Keeps existing data intact up to the new size.

## Syntax



```
realloc(ptr, new_size);
```

- `ptr`: Pointer to previously allocated memory.
- `new_size`: New size in bytes.
- Returns a new pointer to the memory or `NULL` on failure.

## Example



```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>

int main() {
    // Allocate memory for 5 integers
    int *ptr = (int *)calloc(5, sizeof(int));
    // Resize memory to hold 10 integers
    ptr = (int *)realloc(ptr, 10 * sizeof(int));
    // Check if reallocation was successful
    if (ptr == NULL) {
        printf("Memory Reallocation Failed");
        exit(0);
    }
    // Use the reallocated memory
    for (int i = 0; i < 10; i++)
        ptr[i] = i + 1;

    for (int i = 0; i < 10; i++)
        printf("%d ", ptr[i]);
    // Free memory
    free(ptr);
    ptr = NULL;

    return 0;
}
```

Output : 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

## Structure

- A structure is a user-defined data type.
- It allows grouping variables of different data types into a single unit.
- Useful for representing real-world entities like student records, employee info, etc.
- Defined using the struct keyword.

Syntax : Structure Definition

```
struct StructureName {  
    data_type member1;  
    data_type member2;  
    ...  
};
```

## Creating Structure Variable

Method 1: Declare Variables After the Structure Definition

```
struct Student {  
    char name[50];  
    int age;  
    float grade;  
};  
  
// Declaring structure variable  
struct Student s1, s2;
```

## Method 2: Declare Variables With Structure Definition

```
struct Student {  
    char name[50];  
    int age;  
    float grade;  
} s1, s2;
```

## Accessing Structure Members

### 1. Using Dot Operator (.)

- When you have a structure variable, use the dot (.) operator to access or modify its members.

```
structure_variable.member1;  
structure_variable.member2;
```

### 2. Using Arrow Operator (->)

- When you have a pointer to a structure, use the arrow (->) operator to access members.

```
structure_pointer->member1;  
structure_pointer->member2;
```



Example : for structure variable

```
struct Student {  
    int roll;  
    char name[50];  
};  
  
struct Student s1;  
s1.roll = 101;  
strcpy(s1.name, "Shery");
```

Example : for pointer to a structure

```
struct Student s1 = {101, "Shery"};  
struct Student *ptr = &s1;  
  
printf("%d\n", ptr->roll);  
printf("%s\n", ptr->name);
```

## Initialize Structure Members

### 1. Default Initialization

- Structure members are not automatically initialized.
- Without initialization, they may contain garbage values.

```
structure_variable.member1;  
structure_variable.member2;
```

Example :

```
struct Point {
    int x, y;
};

struct Point p = {0}; // Both x and y = 0
```

## 2. Initialization Using Assignment

Example :

```
struct Point p;
p.x = 5;
p.y = 10;
```

## Copying Structures

- Structure variables in C can be copied directly using the assignment operator:
- Syntax : s2 = s1

```
struct Student {
    int id;
    char grade;
};

int main() {
    struct Student s1 = {1, 'A'};
    struct Student s2;
    s2 = s1; // Direct copy
    printf("s2.id = %d, s2.grade = %c\n", s2.id, s2.grade);
    return 0;
}
```

- If the structure contains pointers, only the pointer addresses are copied, not the data they point to.

## Passing Structures to Functions

- **Pass by Value** – makes a copy
- **Pass by Pointer** – avoids copying, can modify original

```
#include <stdio.h>

struct A {
    int x;
};
// a is passed by value, b is passed by pointer
void increment(struct A a, struct A* b) {
    a.x++;      // Only local copy of a is changed
    b->x++;     // Actual b is modified
}

int main() {
    struct A a = {10};
    struct A b = {10};

    increment(a, &b);

    printf("a.x: %d \tb.x: %d\n", a.x, b.x);
    return 0;
}
```

**Output :** a.x: 10    b.x: 11

- a was passed by value, so a.x++ only affected the local copy.
- b was passed by pointer, so b->x++ updated the actual variable.

## Size of Structures

- In theory, the size of a structure should be the sum of the sizes of its members.
- **But in reality,** Most compilers add padding between members to align data in memory for faster access.

## What is Structure Padding?

- Structure Padding is the addition of unused memory bytes between members to ensure proper alignment of data members in memory.

Example : with padding

```
#include <stdio.h>

struct A {
    char c;    // 1 byte
    int i;     // 4 bytes (aligned to 4 bytes)
};

int main() {
    printf("Size of struct A: %lu\n", sizeof(struct A));
    return 0;
}
```

**Output (usually) :** Size of struct A: 8

**Explanation:**

- char c uses 1 byte
- 3 bytes padding are added for alignment
- int i uses 4 bytes
- Total = 1 + 3 + 4 = 8 bytes

## What if you want to disable padding?

- Use Structure Packing to tightly pack members without extra padding.

```

#include <stdio.h>
#pragma pack(1) // Disable padding
struct B {
    char c;
    int i;
};
int main() {
    printf("Size of struct B: %lu\n", sizeof(struct B));
    return 0;
}

```

**Output :** Size of struct B: 5

## Array of Structures

- An array of structures is a collection of structure variables of the same type stored in contiguous memory locations.

```

#include <stdio.h>

struct Student {
    char name[20];
    int age;
    float marks;
};
int main() {
    // Declare an array of 3 Students
    struct Student students[3] = {
        {"Alice", 18, 85.5},
        {"Bob", 19, 90.0},
        {"Charlie", 17, 92.5}
    };

    for (int i = 0; i < 3; i++) {
        printf("Name: %s, Age: %d, Marks: %.2f\n",
            students[i].name, students[i].age, students[i].marks);
    }
    return 0;
}

```

## typedef

- typedef is a keyword in C that allows you to create a new name (alias) for an existing data type.
- This helps make code more readable, manageable, and easier to work with – especially for complex or user-defined types.

Example :

```
#include <stdio.h>

typedef int Integer;

int main() {
    Integer n = 10; // Integer is now an alias for int
    printf("%d", n);
    return 0;
}
```

## typeof with Structures:

- Without typedef:

```
struct Student {
    int id;
    char name[50];
};

struct Student s1;
```

- With typedef:

```
typedef struct {  
    int id;  
    char name[50];  
} Student;  
  
Student s1; // Cleaner syntax
```

## Nested Structures

- One structure inside another.
- This helps you create more organized and complex data types, especially when grouping related data.

## Types of Nesting

### 1. Separate Structure Nesting

- Both inner and outer structures are declared separately, and one is used inside the other.

### 2. Embedded Structure Nesting

- The inner structure is declared inside the outer (parent) structure.

## How to Access Nested Members?

- Use the dot (.) operator twice:

```
str_parent.str_child.member;
```

- Example: **Separate Structure Nesting**

```
#include <stdio.h>
// Child structure declaration
struct child {
    int a;
    char c;
};
// Parent structure declaration
struct parent {
    int b;
    struct child d;
};
int main() {
    struct parent p = { 100, {200, 'L'} };
    // Accessing and printing nested members
    printf("p.b = %d\n", p.b);
    printf("p.d.a = %d\n", p.d.a);
    printf("p.d.c = %c", p.d.c);
    return 0;
}
```

- Example : **Embedded Structure Nesting**

```
#include <stdio.h>

struct parent {
    int a;
    // Inner structure declared inside parent
    struct {
        int x;
        char c;
    } b;
};
int main() {
    struct parent p = { 100, {200, 'L'} };
    printf("p.a = %d\n", p.a);
    printf("p.b.x = %d\n", p.b.x);
    printf("p.b.c = %c", p.b.c);

    return 0;
}
```



## Union

- A union is also a user-defined data type.
- Unlike structure, all union members share the same memory location, so only one member can contain a valid value at a time.
- Useful to save memory when you only need to use one value at a time

Syntax : Union Declaration

```
union UnionName {  
    type1 member1;  
    type2 member2;  
    ...  
};
```

## Variable Creation

Method 1: With Declaration

```
union UnionName {  
    int a;  
    float b;  
} u1, u2;
```

## Method 2: After Declaration

```
union UnionName {  
    int a;  
    float b;  
} u1, u2;
```

## Access Union Members

- Use the dot ( . ) operator, just like structures:

```
u1.a = 5;  
printf("%d", u1.a);
```

## Example

```
#include <stdio.h>  
#include <string.h>  
union A {  
    int i;  
    float f;  
    char s[20];  
};  
int main() {  
    union A a;  
  
    // Storing an integer  
    a.i = 10;  
    printf("data.i = %d\n", a.i);  
    // Storing a float (overwrites integer)  
    a.f = 22.5;  
    printf("data.f = %.2f\n", a.f);  
    // Storing a string (overwrites float)  
    strcpy(a.s, "GfG");  
    printf("data.s = %s\n", a.s);  
    return 0;  
}
```

## Size of Union

- The size of the union will always be equal to the size of the largest member of the union.
- Even though the union contains int, float, and char[20], only the size of the largest member (in this case, char s[20]).

Example :

```
#include <stdio.h>

union A{
    int x;
    char y;
};
union B{
    int arr[10];
    char y;
};
int main() {
    printf("Sizeof A: %ld\n", sizeof(union A));
    printf("Sizeof B: %ld\n", sizeof(union B));
    return 0;
}
```

Output :

Sizeof A: 4

Sizeof B: 40

## #define

- #define is a preprocessor directive used to define:
  - Constants
  - Macros (function-like expressions)
  - Generic macros (with \_Generic keyword)

Syntax : Define a Constant

```
#define MACRO_NAME value
```

Syntax : Define an Expression

```
#define MACRO_NAME (expression)
```

Syntax : Define a Macro with Parameters (Function-like Macro)

```
#define MACRO_NAME(arg1, arg2, ...) (expression using args)
```

Example : Define a Constant

```
#include <stdio.h>
#define PI 3.14159265359

int main() {
    int radius = 21;
    int area = PI * radius * radius;
    printf("Area of Circle of radius %d: %d", radius, area);
    return 0;
}
```

**Output :** Area of Circle of radius 21: 1385

### Example : Define an Expression

```
#include <stdio.h>
#define PI (22 / 7)

int main() {
    int radius = 7;
    int area = PI * radius * radius;
    printf("Area of Circle of radius %d: %d", radius, area);
    return 0;
}
```

**Output :** Area of Circle of radius 7: 147

### Example : Function-like Macros

```
#include <stdio.h>
#define CIRCLE_AREA(r) (3.14 * r * r)
#define SQUARE_AREA(s) (s * s)

int main() {
    int radius = 21, side = 5, area;
    area = CIRCLE_AREA(radius);
    printf("Area of Circle of radius %d: %d\n", radius, area);
    area = SQUARE_AREA(side);
    printf("Area of square of side %d: %d", side, area);
    return 0;
}
```

**Output :** Area of Circle of radius 7: 147

### Important Facts :

- Do not use = in #define. Example: #define PI 3.14 is correct, #define PI = 3.14 is wrong.
- Do not end #define statements with a ;.
- You cannot assign variables to macros.
- Values defined with #define cannot be changed at runtime.
- Macros are replaced during preprocessing, before actual compilation starts.

## enumeration

- An enum (short for enumeration) is a user-defined data type in C. It assigns names to a set of integer constants, making the code:
  - Easier to read
  - Easier to maintain
  - More meaningful than just using raw numbers

Syntax : Define a Constant

```
enum enum_name {  
    constant1, constant2, constant3, ...  
};
```

By default:

- constant1 = 0
- constant2 = 1
- constant3 = 2, and so on...

### Example 1: Simple Enum

```
#include <stdio.h>  
  
enum calculate {  
    SUM, DIFFERENCE, PRODUCT, QUOTIENT  
};  
  
int main() {  
    enum calculate op = PRODUCT;  
    printf("%d\n", op); // Output: 2  
    return 0;  
}
```

## Creating Enum Variables

- After defining an enum, we create variables like this:

```
enum calculate c1;
```

- Enum with Custom Values

```
enum enm {  
    a = 3, b = 2, c  
};
```

Then a = 3, b = 2, and c = 3 (incremented from b).

## Size of Enum

Enums typically take the size of an int (4 bytes), but can vary by compiler.

```
#include <stdio.h>  
  
enum direction { EAST, NORTH, WEST, SOUTH };  
  
int main() {  
    enum direction dir = NORTH;  
    printf("%ld bytes", sizeof(dir)); // Likely 4 bytes  
    return 0;  
}
```

Output : 4 bytes

## Enum + Typedef

Use typedef to avoid writing enum repeatedly.

## Example

```

#include <stdio.h>

typedef enum direction {
    EAST, NORTH, WEST, SOUTH
} Dirctn;

int main() {
    Dirctn d = NORTH;
    printf("%d", d); // Output: 1
    return 0;
}
```

- Enums improve readability and code clarity
- Default values start from 0, or you can assign your own
- Enum variables are usually stored as integers
- Use typedef for convenience



# File Handling

## Why use file handling ?

- To store program output permanently.
- Helps in reading/writing large data.
- Makes data reusable.

## Types of Files

### 1. Text File (.txt)

- Stores ASCII characters.
- Human-readable.

### 2. Binary File (.bin)

- Stores data in binary (0s & 1s).
- Faster, compact, not human-readable.

## Basic File Operations

### Operation

### Function Used

Create/Open

-

fopen()

Read

-

fscanf(), fgets(), fgetc()

Write

-

fprintf(), fputs(), fputc()

Move Pointer

-

fseek(), rewind()

Close File

-

fclose()

## File Pointer

- A file pointer is a reference to a particular position in the opened file.
- Declared using the FILE macro.
- The FILE macro is defined in the <stdio.h> header file.

Syntax :

```
FILE *fptr;
```

## Create/Open a File

```
FILE *fptr = fopen("fileName", "mode");
```

- fileName: name of the file when present in the same directory as the source file. Otherwise, full path.
- mode: Specifies for what operation the file is being opened.
- If the file is opened successfully, returns a file pointer to it. Otherwise returns NULL.

## Modes

- "r" – Read
- "w" – Write (overwrite or create)
- "a" – Append
- "r+", "w+", "a+" – Read + Write
- Add "b" for binary files: "rb", "wb" etc.

Example :

```
#include <stdio.h>
int main() {
    FILE *fptr = fopen("demo.txt", "w");
    if (fptr != NULL) {
        printf("File is created Successfully.!");
    }
    return 0;
}
```

## Read a File

- File reading in C is done using functions like fscanf(), fgets(), fgetc(), etc.
- These functions are similar to scanf, gets, etc., but require a file pointer.

### Functions

### Description

|          |                                        |
|----------|----------------------------------------|
| fscanf() | - Reads formatted input from a file    |
| fgets()  | - Reads a line (string) from a file    |
| fgetc()  | - Reads a single character from a file |
| fgetw()  | - Reads an integer from a file         |
| fread()  | - Reads bytes from a binary file       |

- Use fopen() in "r" (read) mode to open the file.
- File pointer moves automatically after each read.
- Reading functions return EOF (End Of File) when the file ends.
- EOF is a constant that tells reading is complete.

Example :

```
FILE *fptr;
fptr = fopen("fileName.txt", "r");
fscanf(fptr, "%s %s %s %d", str1, str2, str3, &year);
// Reading 100 characters from file
fread(fptr, sizeof(char), 100, fptr);
// Reading a character
char c = fgetc(fptr);
// Reading a line
char line[100];
fgets(line, sizeof(line), fptr);
```

## Write to a File

- Use functions like fprintf(), fputs(), fputc() to write data to files.
- These are similar to printf(), puts(), putchar() but used with a file pointer.

### Functions

### Description

|           |                                                 |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------|
| fprintf() | - Writes formatted text to a file (like printf) |
| fputs()   | - Writes a string (line) to the file            |
| fputc()   | - Writes a single character to the file         |
| fputw()   | - Writes an integer/number to the file          |
| fwrite()  | - Writes bytes of data to a binary file         |

- Use fopen() with "w" mode to write (creates a new file or overwrites).
- Use "a" mode for append (adds to existing file).
- File pointer is needed for all write operations.

Example :

```
FILE *fptr;
fptr = fopen("fileName.txt", "w");
// Writing formatted text
fprintf(fptr, "%s %s %s %d", "We", "are", "in", 2012);
// Writing a single character
fputc('a', fptr);
// Writing a string
fputs("Hello World", fptr);
// Writing a string with size
fwrite("Hello World", sizeof(char), 11, fptr);
```

## Closing a File

- `fclose()` is used to close an opened file.
- It frees the memory and saves changes made to the file.
- Always close a file after reading or writing to avoid data loss.

Syntax :

```
fclose(file_pointer);
```

- `file_pointer` is the pointer returned by `fopen()`.

Example :

```
FILE *fptr;  
fptr = fopen("fileName.txt", "w");  
  
// ----- File operations -----  
  
fclose(fptr); // Closing the file
```

## fseek()

- fseek() is used to move the file pointer to a specific location in the file.
- It helps you avoid reading unnecessary records and makes file access more efficient.

### Syntax :

```
int fseek(FILE *ptr, long int offset, int pos);
```

- ptr: File pointer.
- offset: Number of bytes to move the pointer.
- pos: Position from where to start (can be SEEK\_SET, SEEK\_CUR, or SEEK\_END).
- Parameters of fseek():
  - a. SEEK\_SET: Moves the pointer to a specific position from the beginning of the file.
  - b. SEEK\_CUR: Moves the pointer relative to the current position.
  - c. SEEK\_END: Moves the pointer relative to the end of the file.

### Example :

```
// Move pointer to the 10th byte from the beginning of the file
fseek(fp, 10, SEEK_SET);
// Read the next 10 characters from the current position
fgets(buffer, 11, fp); // 11 because we want to read 10 characters + null terminator
// Print the content read from the file
printf("Data from position 10: %s\n", buffer);
```

### Explanation:

1. Opening the file: We open the file test.txt in read mode.
2. Using fseek(): The pointer is moved to the 10th byte from the beginning of the file (SEEK\_SET).
3. Reading from the file: The fgets() function reads 10 characters from the current position (after seeking).
4. Printing the content: The content read is printed to the console.
5. Closing the file: It's important to close the file after the operation.

### Output Example:

1. If the file test.txt has content like:  
Hello, this is a test file.
1. The output will be:  
Data from position 10: is a test f
1. In this case, the file pointer starts at the 10th byte and reads the next 10 characters.